

- (c) Plastic carrier bags are made from polythene. Each plastic carrier bag can take 500-1000 years to decompose and may never break down in landfill. Paper bags are not necessarily an environmentally friendly alternative. Manufacturing paper bags wastes a lot of natural resources. Even starch-based biodegradable bags use natural resources during their manufacture.

Supermarkets give customers a choice of buying single-use or re-usable polythene carrier bags.

Table 2 shows the number of both types of plastic bag sold in UK supermarkets from 2011 to 2013.

Year	2011	2012	2013
	Number of bags (millions)		
Single-use bags	7977	8079	8455
Re-usable bags	415	408	445

Table 2

- (i) State **one** environmental problem related to the disposal of **all** types of carrier bag. [1]

.....

- (ii) Calculate the percentage of plastic bags sold in 2013 that were single-use bags. [2]

Percentage = %



Examiner
only

(iii) Although more plastic carrier bags were sold in 2013 than 2012, the total **mass** of those bags changed from 70 400 tonnes to 67 300 tonnes.

Put a tick (✓) in **two** boxes next to statements which could explain the reason for the change in mass. [2]

the bags were made the same thickness but from a less dense plastic

☐

customers re-used their plastic bags more often

☐

the bags were made from the same plastic but were thicker

☐

the bags were made from the same plastic but were thinner

☐

the bags were made the same thickness but from a more dense plastic

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